

Dieynab Diatta

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Education

Cornell University

PhD in Applied Economics and Management

Fields: Development Economics

Ithaca, NY

August 2024 – Present

Cornell University

Master of Science in Applied Economics and Management

Ithaca, NY

May 2017

Macalester College

Bachelor of Arts in Economics and International Studies

Saint Paul, MN

May 2014

Research Interests

Development Economics, Labor Economics, Applied Methods

Publications

1. Billings, L., Pradeilles, R., Gillespie, S., Vanderkooy, A., **Diatta, D.**, Toure, M., Diatta, A.D., & Verstraeten, R. (2021). Coherence for nutrition: Insights from nutrition-relevant policies and programmes in Burkina Faso and Nigeria. *Health Policy and Planning*, 36(10), 1574–1592. doi:10.1093/heapol/czab108

Working Papers

2. When It Rains, It Pours: Compounding Shocks and Food Insecurity in Rural Malawi. with Nathan Jensen and Joanna Upton. *Presented at AAEA 2025, Denver, Colorado*
3. Health Insurance and Workers' Employment Choices in Senegal.

Research Experience

World Bank

Research Assistant / Field Coordinator

Dakar, Senegal

Apr. 2021 – Jul. 2024

- Conducted a prospective multi-country randomized controlled trial evaluating anticipatory cash transfers for drought response across the Sahel (Niger, Mauritania, and Senegal), using satellite-based triggers.
- Managed field operations including enumerator recruitment, training, and logistics; oversaw data quality assurance using SurveyCTO.
- Applied quasi-experimental methods (regression discontinuity design) to evaluate technology adoption impacts for 2,000 small businesses in Senegal; coordinated with government ministries and local authorities throughout.

IFPRI

Research Assistant

Dakar, Senegal

Apr. 2019 – Apr. 2021

- Assessed nutrition intervention coverage and data quality across West Africa using mixed methods, including stakeholder interviews and secondary data triangulation.

- Conducted systematic review and meta-analysis on breastfeeding interventions across 11 West African countries; findings disseminated through TNWA Evidence Notes and a peer-reviewed journal article.
- Applied gender-disaggregated analysis across nutrition program assessments; engaged with national ministries, UN agencies, and regional partners to validate findings and support policy dialogue.

IFAD

Research Assistant

Rome, Italy

Jun. 2017 – Apr. 2019

- Led impact assessment of the Agricultural Value Chains Support Project (PAFA) in Senegal, applying inverse probability weighted regression adjustment (IPWRA) to estimate treatment effects for 2,227 rural farmers.
- Designed household and community surveys, trained and supervised enumerators, and managed multi-site data collection in rural Senegal.
- Produced final impact assessment report aligned with IFAD’s Results and Impact Management System (RIMS) standards. (*Published: SSRN, 2019*)

Cornell University

Research Assistant

Ithaca, NY

Oct. 2015 – Jan. 2016

- Analyzed resilience measurement methods and synthesized findings to advance a conceptual and empirical framework for development resilience in smallholder contexts.

ICRISAT

Research Scholar

Hyderabad, India

Jun. – Aug. 2016

- Analyzed intra-household food allocation and its effects on adolescent nutrition and food security outcomes in rural South Asia. Designed household surveys, trained enumerators, and supervised data collection.

Reports & Policy Papers

- Garbero, A., Diatta, D., & Olapade, M. (2019). *IFAD Impact Assessment – Agricultural Value Chains Support Project (PAFA): Senegal*. SSRN Electronic Journal.
- Diatta, D., Billings, L., & Verstraeten, R. (2021). *West Africa’s data story: The availability of actionable nutrition data*. TNWA Evidence Note 24. Dakar: IFPRI.
- Salm, L., Touré, M., Diatta, D., Campbell, F., Booth, A., & Verstraeten, R. (2021). *Effectiveness and implementation analysis of interventions to improve exclusive and early initiation of breastfeeding in West Africa*. TNWA Evidence Note 21. Dakar: IFPRI.
- Touré, M., Becquey, E., Huybregts, L., Diatta, D., Booth, A., & Verstraeten, R. (2021). *Evidence mapping of wasting programs and their impact along the continuum of care in low- and middle-income countries*. TNWA Evidence Note 23. Dakar: IFPRI.
- Diatta, D. (2017). *An empirical investigation of shock metrics for resilience: The relationship between self-reported shocks and objective indicators*. Unpublished master’s thesis, Cornell University.

Teaching Experience

Cornell University, Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management Ithaca, NY

Teaching Assistant

AEM 2350 — Introduction to the Economics of Development Fall 2026

ECON 1120 – Introduction to Macroeconomics Spring 2026

AEM 5600 — Managerial Economics Fall 2025

AEM 4060 — Risk Simulation and Monte Carlo Methods Spring 2016

Service

Peer Mentor, STARS Fellowship , Cornell University 2026

Speaker, Graduate Applications International Network (GAIN) 2025

Skills

Methods: Impact evaluation, quasi-experimental methods (RDD, IPWRA), mixed-methods design, survey design, data quality assurance

Software: Stata, R, QGIS, SurveyCTO, GitHub

Languages: English (Fluent), French (Native), Wolof (Native), Spanish (Intermediate)